

Terry Ballad

Principal Technical Program Manager | Cross-Functional Execution & Platform Delivery

Agile SaaS • Enterprise Technology • Program Infrastructure • AI-Enabled Delivery

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Technical program leader with 20+ years of hands-on software and platform experience and 15+ years driving cross-functional execution across engineering, product, compliance, and operations. Proven ability to build program operating infrastructure from the ground up - dependency tracking, risk cadences, stakeholder alignment frameworks, and working group governance - in ambiguous, multi-team environments.

Deep technical foundation across SaaS, cloud, and security-sensitive platforms enables credible partnership with engineers and architects on architecture boundaries, sequencing decisions, and technical trade-offs. Strong executive communicator who translates complex technical risk into business-legible recommendations without losing credibility with the engineering teams executing the work. Track record of owning outcomes, not tasks - proactively stepping into execution gaps and building durable operational infrastructure that outlasts individual programs.

PROGRAM LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES

Cross-functional program ownership • Dependency and risk management • Operating cadence design • Stakeholder alignment

Release and launch readiness • Architecture and sequencing review • Executive communication • Program governance frameworks

Agile delivery (Scrum & Kanban) • Backlog and sprint coordination • Vendor and compliance coordination • Technical documentation

CORE SKILLS

- **Technology:** Strategy and roadmaps, SaaS and cloud platforms (AWS), Software engineering, Build vs. buy analysis, Vendor selection and contracting, Data governance and security controls
- **AI & Automation:** LLM-assisted PDLC workflows, Prompt design, Human-in-the-loop review, AI risk and governance, Workflow automation (Power Automate), Custom GPT configuration, Rapid prototyping
- **Tools:** Jira, Asana, Trello, MS Project, Notion, ClickUp
- **Technical:** PHP, Python, React, Node.js, SQL
- **Cloud & Infra:** AWS, GitHub, Cloudflare / Digital Ocean

AI & AUTOMATION PROGRAM EXPERIENCE

- Championed AI adoption across the product development lifecycle - modeling LLM-assisted requirements discovery, prototyping, code review, and documentation workflows that reduced cycle time across SaaS and consulting engagements.
- Built SignalForge, an AI-powered lead intelligence platform for fractional consultants, using LLM-based discovery and a custom multi-dimensional scoring system (LGPS) - designed, architected, and shipped end-to-end.
- Designed and deployed workflow automation solutions using Microsoft Power Automate to streamline operational approval processes, reducing manual coordination overhead and improving status visibility across departments.
- Built and delivered AI-assisted SaaS prototypes and internal tools using LLM-assisted development workflows, including custom GPT configurations and human-in-the-loop review processes.
- Evaluated and governed AI usage risks including data exposure, hallucination handling, and responsible AI integration patterns across client and internal programs.
- Completing Human-Centered AI Leadership Certification - MIT Collaboration.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fractional CTO / Technical Program Strategist

DisEntangled Tech, LLC.

2025 - Present

Provide technical program leadership to SaaS companies, startups, and mission-driven organizations - translating business objectives into cross-functional execution plans and managing delivery from discovery through launch.

AI-Enabled Program Delivery

- Built program operating infrastructure for AI-assisted SaaS engagements including a cybersecurity operations platform and SignalForge, owning scope, sequencing, dependency management, and release readiness end-to-end.
- Used LLM-assisted workflows to accelerate requirements validation, prototype iteration, and delivery documentation - modeling AI adoption practices for client engineering teams.
- Evaluated AI integration risks - data exposure, hallucination handling, human-in-the-loop checkpoints - and embedded governance into program delivery frameworks.

Cross-Functional Program Execution

- Designed program governance frameworks - dependency tracking, risk reporting cadences, stakeholder communication rhythms - from scratch for early-stage and scaling organizations.
- Conducted stakeholder discovery and translated business requirements into technical specifications, epics, and sequenced delivery plans aligned to architecture constraints.
- Facilitated alignment between executive stakeholders and engineering teams on scope, acceptance criteria, sequencing trade-offs, and release expectations.
- Identified technical risks early and adjusted scope, sequencing, or design to protect delivery timelines and product quality.

Key Engagement: 12 Skies Tech (Development Agency Partnership)

- Acted as execution owner between business stakeholders, clients, and software engineers - running discovery, translating findings into epics and acceptance criteria, and managing delivery dependencies.
- Established structured handoff documentation supporting development, QA, and onboarding; improved delivery predictability and reduced rework.

Director of Technology - Product & Platform Delivery

EXACT Sports

2025

Led delivery and operations for a national SaaS platform. Rebuilt program execution infrastructure while launching new products and stabilizing platform reliability.

- Launched three SaaS products within six months, coordinating cross-functional delivery across engineering, infrastructure, and business stakeholders.
- Rebuilt program operating cadences - sprint planning, dependency tracking, release readiness - improving delivery throughput by 150%+ while reducing critical outages by 75% through monitoring and operational reliability improvements.
- Established Agile delivery practices and structured workflows; supported engineering teams in defining technical approaches and implementation sequencing.
- Grew the engineering team by 250% while improving productivity by 150%.

PMO Coordinator - Enterprise Technology Portfolio

Chicago Transit Authority

2023 - 2024

Oversaw a large enterprise technology portfolio spanning data, security, and application initiatives across multiple vendors and engineering teams. Managed \$135M+ technology portfolio.

- Built program governance infrastructure from scratch - dependency tracking, risk reporting, stakeholder communication cadences - across a multi-team, multi-vendor enterprise portfolio with no prior unified program framework.
- Served as liaison between executive leadership, technical teams, and vendors throughout the project lifecycle; reviewed and clarified technical requirements, SOWs, and vendor deliverables.
- Designed and implemented a workflow automation solution using Microsoft Power Automate to streamline procurement contract approvals - mapped workflows, gathered requirements, translated into automated routing rules, and reduced approval delays across departments.
- Supported governmentally mandated audits through documentation of systems, controls, and operational processes.

Program Manager

Assurance Data

2021 - 2022

- Led FedRAMP readiness program end-to-end - coordinating engineering, compliance, security, and executive stakeholders through a multi-phase, high-stakes initiative with regulatory delivery consequences.
- Owned program lifecycle from discovery through release and operational handoff: managed backlog prioritization, dependency tracking, sprint alignment, and release readiness across engineering, marketing, and leadership stakeholders.

Founder / Digital Transformation Consultant

Disentangled Tech, LLC.

2004 - 2023

- Led digital transformation programs - system integrations, platform launches, workflow modernization - for small businesses and organizations over nearly two decades.
- Gathered requirements, defined system workflows, and coordinated implementation across vendors and developers; oversaw system integrations and launch execution.

EARLIER ENGINEERING CAREER

- Web Programmer - Follett Library Resources
- Systems Engineer - RBS Greenwich Capital
- Web Application Programmer - TransUnion

FOUNDER & TECHNICAL CO-FOUNDER EXPERIENCE

- Pchy - Technical Co-Founder (2024)
- Subsidio - Technical Co-Founder (2023 - 2024)
- Disentangled Tech - Founder (2004 - Present)

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- Human-Centered AI Leadership - MIT Collaboration
- PMI-ACP (Agile Certified Practitioner) - Project Management Institute
- BA, Computer Science and Creative Writing - Bradley University

PUBLICATIONS

- Access Control, Authentication, and Public Key Infrastructure - Jones & Bartlett Learning
- Securing PHP Web Applications - Addison-Wesley Professional
- PHP and MySQL Web Development All-in-One Desk Reference for Dummies - Wiley